AI Product Photos for Online Sellers

Free quick study · November 13, 2026 · General information, not financial or legal advice. Results are not guaranteed.

1. The secret, in one line

Brands used to book a studio, a photographer and sometimes a stylist for every product. Today a phone photo plus a free AI editor (for example Photoroom or Pixelcut on their free plans) can turn a messy-table snapshot into a clean white-background or lifestyle shot in minutes, and you can sell that result to shops that still have weak photos.

2. What customers already pay (published figures)

Measure	Published figure	Source
Professional product photo	$50–$350 per image	Shopify, Jan 27, 2026
Product photo day rate	$500–$3,000 per day	Shopify, Jan 27, 2026
White-background vs lifestyle (vendor blogs)	about $25–$75 vs $150–$500 per image	Secondary vendor blogs (e.g. Claid)

3. Startup cost

$0 if you stay on free plans (Photoroom, Pixelcut, ChatGPT image tools). Optional paid plans are often around $10/month. A phone with a decent camera, a window for light and a plain sheet are enough to start.

4. Requirements checklist

✓ **WITH AI (free tools)**	✗ without AI
✓ **NO REAL ESTATE needed**	✗ needs real estate
✓ **NO BUILDING needed**	✗ needs building
✓ **NO OFFICE needed (phone or laptop)**	✗ needs office
✓ **NO LAND needed**	✗ needs land

5. Steps to start

1. Photograph the product on your phone near a window; take 3–4 angles.
2. Open Photoroom (free plan), remove the background and tap a studio or lifestyle background.
3. Export, compare before and after, and fix anything that changes how the real product looks.
4. Build a small portfolio of 5–10 before/after pairs using your own items or a friend's shop.
5. Offer a clear package (for example a 10-photo set per product) with a fixed price.

6. How to get the first customers

• Etsy, Shopify and Amazon sellers whose listings have dark or cluttered photos: send them one free before/after of their own product.
• Local boutiques, candle, soap, jewelry and food makers who sell on Instagram.

• Marketplace groups for small sellers; post your before/after pairs.

7. How it earns

Illustration only, not a promise: if a shop that would otherwise pay a studio $50+ per image buys a 10-photo set from you, that is one job; your price will be lower than a studio at first. Repeat work comes from new products and seasonal photos.

8. Risks and honest limits

• The photo must stay honest: do not change the product's color, size or details; marketplaces and buyers punish misleading images.
• Free plans may limit exports, resolution or add watermarks; check before you promise a client.
• Competition is growing; your edge is finding sellers and delivering fast, not the tool itself.

9. Our rating

Difficulty: 2/5	Speed to profit: 4/5	First income: ~1–2 weeks (our estimate)

Sources (read Nov 13, 2026): Shopify, "Product Photography Pricing" shopify.com/blog/product-photography-pricing · Photoroom (free plan) photoroom.com · Pixelcut (free plan) pixelcut.ai. Prices vary by city and client; vendor pages and free plans change, so re-check before quoting.

Want a detailed study for your project or an AI assistant to run your business? Message us.